How the research changed our scope

The process did not move directly from one problem to one interface. We repeatedly adjusted who the service was for and what kind of knowledge it needed.

Our early position

We began with the belief that knowing preferences before arrival would help prepare a room that felt like home. That position made preference collection appear to be the central design problem.

The guest and agent research shifted our attention towards the person representing the staying guest. An assistant might know routines and schedules but still need to recognise which hotel arrangements were possible. This gave us a reason to explore visible, concrete choices rather than only an empty text field.

The second shift: care in context

At Shenzhen MO, the Dream Maker role suggested that relevant needs could emerge in a conversation or situation that a pre-arrival form could never fully predict. We widened the service from a collection interface to a relationship between preparation, observation and response.

Our original four-line workshop statement therefore connected guest, agent and staff knowledge and asked what “feeling at home” meant to each guest. The shared guest profile and handoff process became part of the concept, alongside the online touchpoint.

The challenge inside our own evidence

The 19 September assistant transcript prevents a simple “phones and texts are inefficient” conclusion. Familiarity made requests easier; a trusted manager mattered; privacy could make less disclosure the right outcome. We therefore treat visual expression as an option for a specific need, not a universal replacement channel.

The supplied GXP deck also prevents an “MO has no process” conclusion. It documents existing information categories and traces. This case study now describes our proposal as building on that foundation and gives the narrower claims explicit limits.

Working context	The design implication we retained
Before arrival	Help the assistant recognise and communicate selected possibilities; acknowledge the request.
In person	Allow contextual discovery, with clarification and respect for privacy.
Across teams	Translate a chosen response into a feasible plan with an owner and a visible status.
After delivery	Keep outcomes and rejected assumptions available for learning, subject to policy.

This is a retrospective account of the reasoning. It does not imply that every qualification was resolved in the final presentation.